

XUEJIAN (RON) WANG

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Agricultural Economics, Purdue University	expected August 2027
Advisor: Joseph Balagtas	
M.Sc. Applied Economics, University of Idaho	August 2023
M.A. International Trade, Zhejiang University of Finance & Economics	July 2021
B.A. Economics, Yunnan University	July 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agricultural Economics; Food Marketing and Demand Estimation; Food, Nutrition, and Health Policy; Empirical Industrial Organization

JOB MARKET PAPER

- **“The Effects of GLP-1 Medications on Household Food Demand”** (with Joseph Balagtas)

Some of the first evidence on how GLP-1 medications change household food demand and its nutritional content. A GLP-1 survey inside the NielsenIQ Consumer Panel links each household's adoption to its grocery purchases; harmonized Nutrition Facts data attach calories and nutrients to every product. Matched staggered difference-in-differences estimates show that spending falls more than calories. The basket shrinks but does not get healthier — fiber, fat, protein, and sodium all fall at adoption, while sugar does not. Status: In preparation.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- **Wang, X.**, Balagtas, J. “The Supply Response to Food Quality Concerns: An Application to Synthetic Dyes”
- **Wang, X.**, Balagtas, J. “GLP-1 Medications and the Derived Demand for Meat”

WORKING PAPERS

- **Wang, X.**, Katare, B., Kundu, D. “Natural Disasters and Alcohol Sales: Evidence from Hurricanes.” *SSRN Working Paper*. ssrn.com/abstract=6999318

PUBLICATIONS

- Katare, B., **Wang, X.**, Zhao, S., Yenerall, J. (2025). “Novel Approaches to Analyze Consumer Behavior and Policies to Promote Sustainable Consumption”, *Agricultural Economics*, 56: 512–525. doi.org/10.1111/agec.70027
- Du, X., **Wang, X.** and Hatzenbuehler, P. (2022). “Digital Technology in Agriculture: A Review of Issues, Applications, and Methodologies”, *China Agricultural Economic Review*, Vol. 15 No. 1, pp. 95–108. doi.org/10.1108/CAER-01-2022-0009

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- “The Effects of GLP-1 Medications on Household Food Demand” — ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC (2027, scheduled); AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (2026)
- “The Supply Response to Food Quality Concerns: An Application to Synthetic Dyes” — AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (2026)
- “Natural Disasters and Alcohol Sales: Evidence from Hurricanes” — MEA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL (2026); CES North America Annual Meeting, Ann Arbor, MI (2025); SEA Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL (2025)
- “Market, Environmental, and Policy Implications of Manure-based Fertilizer Development in Idaho: An Agent-Based Approach” — WAEA–CAES Annual Meeting, Whistler, BC, Canada (2023)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Guest Lecturer: AGE 250: Economic Geography of World Food and Resources, Spring 2026
Designed and taught a two-session introductory R module and its data assignment

RESEARCH FUNDING

2024	Jim and Neta Hicks Graduate Student Small Grant, Purdue University (Role: proposal author)	\$7,500
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AWARDS

2022	Edward J. and Maud R. Iddings Research Fellowship, University of Idaho	\$4,000
2022	AAEA Travel Award	

REFeree SERVICE

- Agricultural Economics

SERVICE

Purdue University	Social Chair, Treasurer, Graduate Student Mentor, Graduate Student Organization, Department of Agricultural Economics
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University of Idaho	International Student Ambassador, International Programs Office
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METHODS AND SKILLS

Methods	Applied microeconometrics: matched staggered difference-in-differences with heterogeneity-robust estimators; event-study designs; panel and reduced-form policy evaluation
Data	Construction of large household- and product-level panels from consumer panel and retail scanner data (NielsenIQ, Kilts Center); harmonization of nutrition data across multiple product-level sources; linking survey responses to household purchase records; extraction of product attributes from packaging images (color measurement from photographed product sets)
Tools	Python, R, Stata, HPC, GIS, $\LaTeX$; reproducible, version-controlled data pipelines